



Figure 4: Employment share and real earnings trends for entry level versus experienced workers. Entry level workers are defined as workers aged 26 or younger.

evidence of an increase in employment in software development. These findings suggest that job posting and employment trends need not coincide and may offer different, complementary signals for tracking trends in the job market. Another way to see this is that the trend in Figure 5 occurred across sectors even as the US national unemployment rate and labor force participation rate remained relatively stable.

What explains the divergence between job posting trends and employment trends? Growing labor demand would explain employment growth for software developers but not declines in job postings. Growing labor supply would also explain greater employment for software developers but not stable wages, all else equal. Explaining these trends requires a more nuanced story that would be valuable to explore in future work.⁸

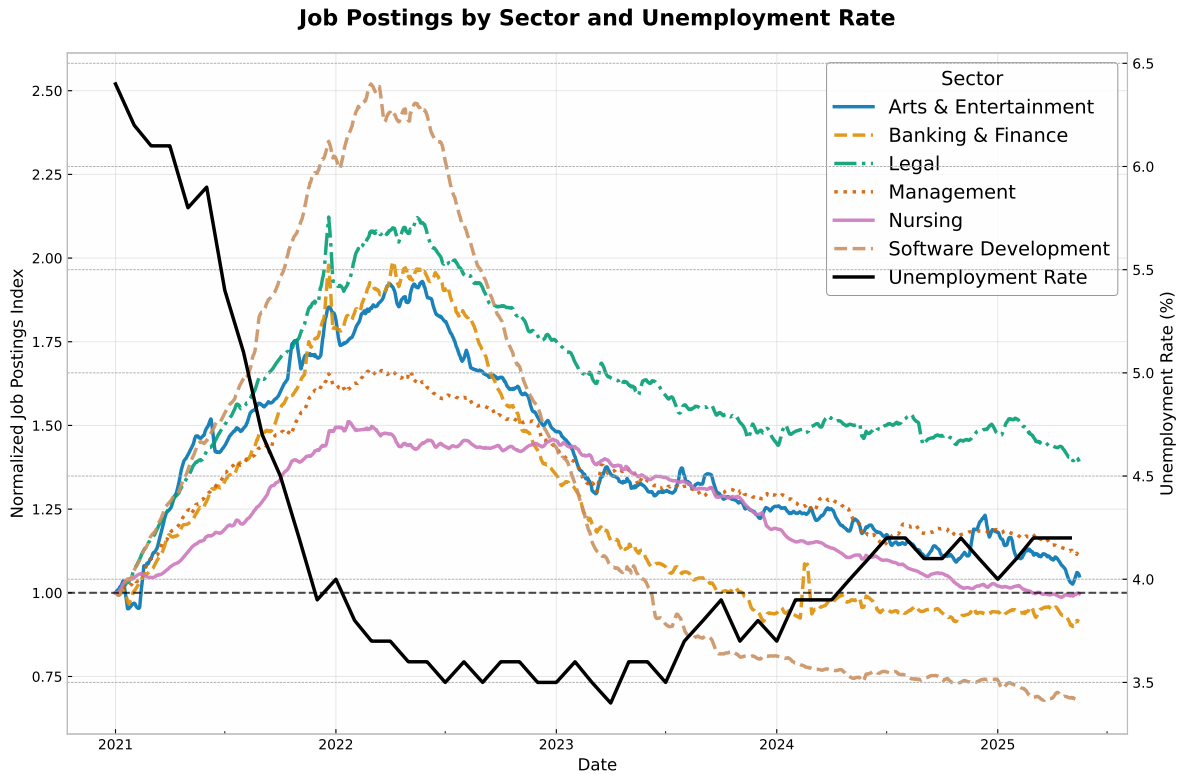


Figure 5: Job postings trends for software developers and other occupations. Data comes from Indeed. National unemployment rate is from the BLS.

⁸Another explanation is that a smaller share of jobs are posted on Indeed, though sites such as Ashby and TrueUp find similar patterns (Bryce Codell, 2023; Lenny Rachitsky, 2025).

6 Conclusion

This paper uses the CPS to provide an empirical snapshot of the US labor market in the initial years since the generative AI revolution. Overall, occupations highly exposed to AI have not experienced employment declines. However, within this group, employment in occupations like software development continues to grow, while it has fallen in like customer service. These trends are correlated with occupational education levels.

These results for employment and earnings contrast with trends in job posting data. This divergence serves as a methodological caution for using job postings as a proxy for these other labor market indicators.

Further research that provides real-time tracking of employment in AI-exposed occupations using large-scale administrative or survey data would be invaluable for assessing how these new technologies are shaping the labor market.

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